HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must have everyone's approval"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must have everyone's approval." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Whose approval did I need growing up?
- ☐ Can anyone please everyone?
- ☐ What am I afraid will happen if someone disapproves?
- ☐ Whose approval matters most?
- ☐ What have I given up to please others?
- ☐ Where could I be honest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I live for God's approval, not man's.
- ☐ The fear of man is a snare.
- ☐ God already accepts me in Christ.
- ☐ No one can please everyone.
- ☐ Disapproval is uncomfortable, not dangerous.
- ☐ I can say no and still be kind.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Galatians 1:10**
  "Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ."
- ☐ **Proverbs 29:25**
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ **Colossians 3:23**
  "Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When I sought approval: Each day, write one time you did something mainly for approval, and one time you acted on your own convictions.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 1:10 becomes: "Mark can write: "I'm not living to please people. I already have God's approval in Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Say one kind no. Decline one request this week that you would normally accept to avoid disapproval.
- [ ] Share an honest opinion. Express a different opinion respectfully in a safe setting.
- [ ] Notice the people-pleasing. Each time you change your behavior to win approval, ask, "Whose approval am I seeking?"
- [ ] Rest in God's approval. Read Galatians 1:10 each morning and remind yourself that God already accepts you in Christ.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must have everyone's approval": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I acted on my convictions
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must have everyone's approval.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have spent so much energy trying to please everyone. Thank You that I already have Your approval in Christ. Free me from the fear of man, and help me live honestly and lovingly for You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.